

CHAPTER 63.

An Act to amend the Defence of the Realm Act, 1914.

[28th August 1914.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Extension of
power to
make regu-
lations.

4 & 5 Geo 5.
c. 29.

1. The Defence of the Realm Act, 1914, shall have effect as if—

(a) at the end of paragraph (a) of section one thereof the following words were inserted, "or to prevent the spread of reports likely to cause disaffection or alarm";

(b) at the end of paragraph (b) of section one thereof there were added the following words, "or of any area which may be proclaimed by the Admiralty or Army Council to be an area which it is necessary to safeguard in the interests of the training or concentration of any of His Majesty's Forces";

(c) at the end of section one there were inserted the following words, "and may by such regulations also provide for the suspension of any restrictions on the acquisition or user of land, or the exercise of the power of making byelaws, or any other power under the Defence Acts, 1842 to 1875, or the Military Lands Acts, 1891 to 1903."

Short title.

2. This Act may be cited as the Defence of the Realm (No. 2) Act, 1914.

CHAPTER 64.

An Act to extend and amend section eight of the Customs and Inland Revenue Act, 1879. [28th August 1914.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

Extension of
42 & 43 Vict.
c. 21. s. 8.

1. Section eight of the Customs and Inland Revenue Act, 1879, (which enables the exportation of certain articles to be prohibited) shall have effect, whilst a state of war in which His Majesty is engaged exists, as if, in addition to the articles therein mentioned, there were included all other articles of every description.

2. Any proclamation or Order in Council made under the said section as so amended may, whilst a state of war exists, be varied or added to by an Order made by the Lords of the Council on the recommendation of the Board of Trade.

3. This Act may be cited as the Customs (Exportation Prohibition) Act, 1914.

CHAPTER 65.

An Act to give Powers in connection with the present War to obtain information as to Stocks of Articles of Commerce, and for enabling Possession to be taken of any such Articles unreasonably withheld.

[28th August 1914.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows :

1.—(1) For the purpose of obtaining information as to the quantity in the United Kingdom or in transit to the United Kingdom of any article of commerce, the Board of Trade may, by notice served by registered post or otherwise on any person, require him to make a return to the Board, within such time as may be specified in the notice, giving such particulars of any article of commerce of which he is the owner as may be required by the notice.

Power to require returns, &c.

(2) For the purpose of testing the accuracy of any return made to the Board under this section, or of obtaining information in case of a failure to make a return, any officer of the Board authorised in that behalf by the Board may enter any premises on which he has reason to believe that there are kept or stored any articles which have been or were required to be included in the return, and of which the person making or required to make the return is or was the owner, and may carry out such inspections of, and examinations on, the premises as the officer may consider necessary for testing the accuracy of the return or for obtaining such information.

(3) If any person—

- (a) wilfully refuses or without lawful excuse neglects to make a return under this Act to the best of his knowledge and belief ; or
- (b) wilfully makes or causes to be made any false return ; or